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Sub : ASD&D Lab

EXPERIMENT NO. 07

Aim: To implement monitoring using Prometheus / Grafana / Nagios

LO Mapping: LO5

LO5: Implement ML lifecycle management and automated workflows using MLflow, Airflow, and monitoring tools like Prometheus/Grafana/Nagios.

Theory:

Continuous monitoring is a process to detect, report, respond all the attacks which occur in its infrastructure. Once the application is deployed into the server, the role of continuous monitoring comes in to play. The entire process is all about taking care of the company's infrastructure and respond appropriately.

Why We Need Nagios tool?

Here, are the important reasons to use Nagios monitoring tool:

- Detects all types of network or server issues
- Helps you to find the root cause of the problem which allows you to get the permanent solution to the problem
- Active monitoring of your entire infrastructure and business processes
- Allows you to monitor and troubleshoot server performance issues
- Helps you to plan for infrastructure upgrades before outdated systems create failures
- You can maintain the security and availability of the service
- Automatically fix problems in a panic situation

- Nagios is the most popular, open source, powerful monitoring system for any kind of infrastructure. It enables organizations to identify and resolve IT infrastructure problems before they affect critical business processes. Nagios has the capability of monitoring applications, services and entire IT infrastructure.
- NRPE is known as Nagios Remote Plugin Executor. It is designed to execute plugins on remote systems. On Windows hosts, the equivalent remote agent is NSClient++, which listens for Nagios requests and executes local checks (disk, CPU, memory, services, etc.).
- NSClient++ runs as a Windows service on the remote host and waits for requests from the Nagios server (usually over the NRPE protocol, which NSClient++ also supports). When the Nagios server needs to check a resource on that host, it sends a command; NSClient++ executes the check locally and returns the result to Nagios.

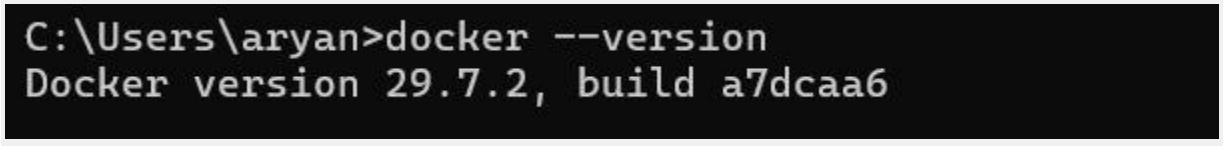
Note on running Nagios on Windows

Nagios Core is built for Linux and does not install natively on Windows. The standard practice for a Windows machine is to run the Nagios Core server inside a Docker container (using Docker Desktop with the WSL2 backend), and to monitor Windows hosts using NSClient++, which is the Windows counterpart of NRPE. All commands below are Windows PowerShell / Command Prompt commands.

1 - Pre-requisite: Install Docker Desktop

Download and install Docker Desktop for Windows and enable the WSL2 based engine. Verify the installation from PowerShell:

```
PS C:\Users\vishal> docker --version
```




```
PS C:\Users\vishal> docker version
```

```
C:\Users\aryan>docker version
Client:
 Version:           29.7.2
 API version:       1.55
 Go version:        go1.26.5
 Git commit:        a7dcaa6
 Built:             Wed Aug  5 18:31:33 2026
 OS/Arch:           windows/amd64
 Context:           desktop-linux

Server: Docker Desktop 4.90.0 (238679)
 Engine:
  Version:          29.7.2
  API version:      1.55 (minimum version 1.40)
  Go version:       go1.26.5
  Git commit:       6a43e3d
  Built:            Wed Aug  5 18:28:36 2026
  OS/Arch:          linux/amd64
  Experimental:     false
 containerd:
  Version:          v2.3.3
  GitCommit:        aad11006b869517fcd3009450b6f82da282e1a9b
 runc:
  Version:          1.4.3
  GitCommit:        v1.4.3-0-gbb14dabe
 docker-init:
  Version:          0.19.0
  GitCommit:        de40ad0
```

Also make sure the WSL2 feature is enabled:

PS C:\Users\vishal> wsl --install

```
C:\Users\aryan>wsl --install
Downloading: Ubuntu
Installing: Ubuntu
Distribution successfully installed. It can be launched via 'wsl.exe -d Ubuntu'
Launching Ubuntu...
Provisioning the new WSL instance Ubuntu
This might take a while...
Create a default Unix user account: aryanK
Invalid username. A valid username must start with a lowercase letter or underscore,
Create a default Unix user account: aryan_18
New password:
Retype new password:
passwd: password updated successfully
usermod: no changes
Help improve Ubuntu!
```

PS C:\Users\vishal> wsl --set-default-version 2

```
C:\Users\aryan>wsl --set-default-version 2
For information on key differences with WSL 2 please visit https://aka.ms/wsl2
The operation completed successfully.
```

2 - Pull and Run the Nagios Core Docker Image

Pull a ready-made Nagios Core image and run it as a container, mapping the web port to the host.

PS C:\Users\vishal> docker pull jasonrivers/nagios:latest

```
C:\Users\aryan>docker pull jasonrivers/nagios:latest
latest: Pulling from jasonrivers/nagios
6fe99ef1bed3: Pull complete
cb259a83ac3d: Pull complete
fdbaa15b8986: Pull complete
f2f9a1b3ce48: Pull complete
7edde1931fd2: Pull complete
1413dee23aae: Pull complete
c5701b5e1540: Pull complete
f47c3af6bf44: Pull complete
a03720c2c16b: Pull complete
c42073aaf047: Pull complete
7a7447982198: Pull complete
748b632e75e7: Pull complete
80b6ab7aef5d: Pull complete
37f75c8146e2: Pull complete
a80db686d641: Pull complete
d003d4303177: Pull complete
a6b90b5bbb15: Pull complete
2908452ff193: Pull complete
dc3a88012a3e: Pull complete
e4dc1d4e010c: Pull complete
0d59a81a5608: Pull complete
e68fcda12c0c: Pull complete
50ea270d34e9: Pull complete
1b9771f55a12: Pull complete
9288c4992679: Pull complete
59215b8e47cf: Pull complete
54b9e993e315: Pull complete
a7bd6dce6a77: Pull complete
254354b70ac0: Pull complete
Digest: sha256:fee9cd6a2933e790dde613d70c3a603f96978d65fa6bbc3d617fce807e00f2e2
Status: Downloaded newer image for jasonrivers/nagios:latest
docker.io/jasonrivers/nagios:latest
```

PS C:\Users\vishal> docker run --name nagios4 -d -p 8080:80 jasonrivers/nagios:latest

```
C:\Users\aryan>docker run --name nagios4 -d -p 8080:80 jasonrivers/nagios:latest
02b310c7bc23052a8c68f3c64c4d697b9575cec1a0b22c1741289c93535c2122
```

Verify the container is up and running:

PS C:\Users\vishal> docker ps

```
C:\Users\aryan>docker ps
CONTAINER ID   IMAGE                     COMMAND             CREATED         STATUS         PORTS                                      NAMES
02b310c7bc23   jasonrivers/nagios:latest  "/usr/local/bin/star…"  19 seconds ago  Up 18 seconds  0.0.0.0:8080->80/tcp, [::]:8080->80/tcp  nagios4
```

3 - Set the Apache/Nagios Admin Password

Set (or reset) the password for the nagiosadmin user inside the running container:

PS C:\Users\vishal> docker exec -it nagios4 htpasswd -c /opt/nagios/etc/htpasswd.users nagiosadmin

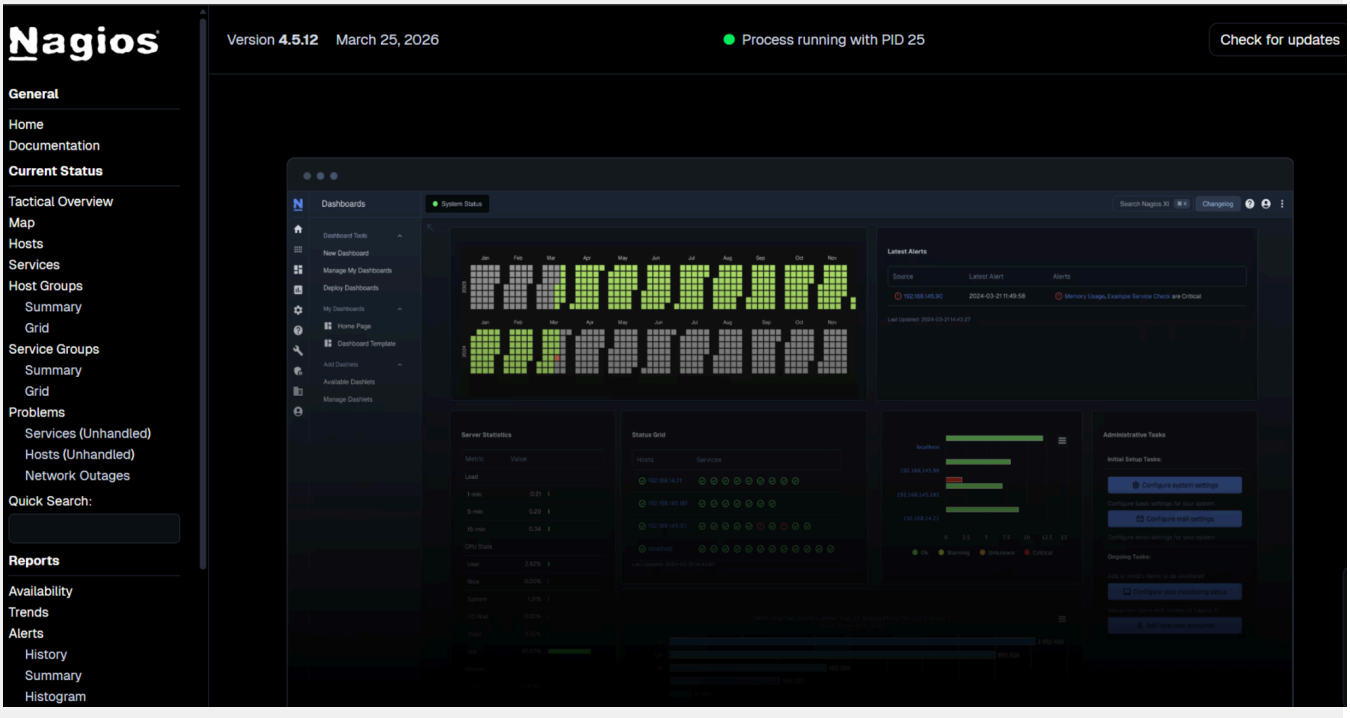
```
C:\Users\aryan>docker exec -it nagios4 htpasswd -c /opt/nagios/etc/htpasswd.users nagiosadmin
New password:
Re-type new password:
Adding password for user nagiosadmin
```

Enter and confirm the password when prompted (e.g. 123456).

4 - Access Nagios Web Interface

Access the Nagios web interface from a browser on the Windows host:

http://localhost:8080/nagios/



Prompting for Authentication Password -

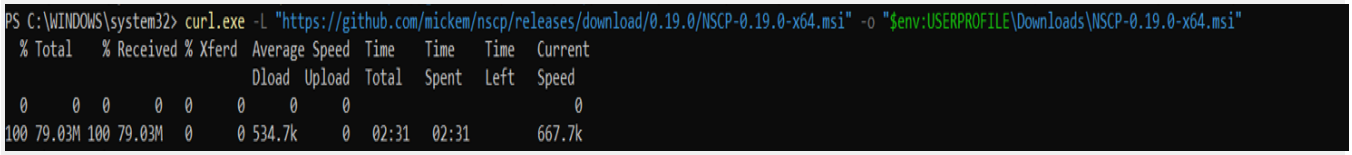
username: nagiosadmin

Password: 123456 (which you entered while configuration)

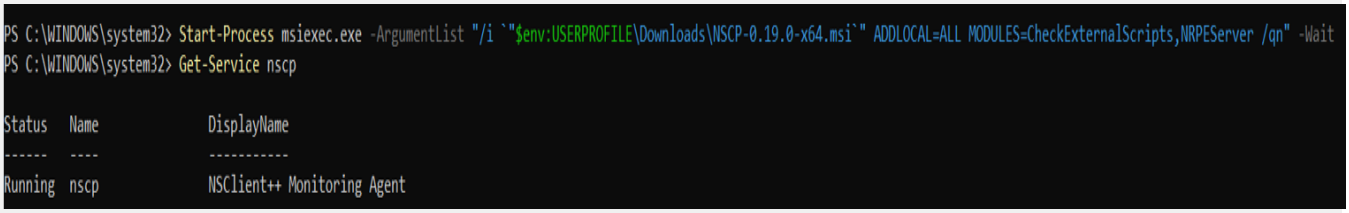
5 - Install NSClient++ on the Windows Remote Host

On the Windows machine you want to monitor, download and silently install NSClient++ (the Windows equivalent of the NRPE agent):

```
PS C:\Users\vishal> Invoke-WebRequest -Uri "https://github.com/mickem/nscp/releases/latest/download/NSCP-0.5.2-x64.msi" -OutFile "NSCP.msi"
```




```
PS C:\Users\vishal> Start-Process msiexec.exe -ArgumentList '/i NSCP.msi ADDLOCAL=ALL MODULES=CheckExternalScripts,NRPEServer /qn' -Wait
```

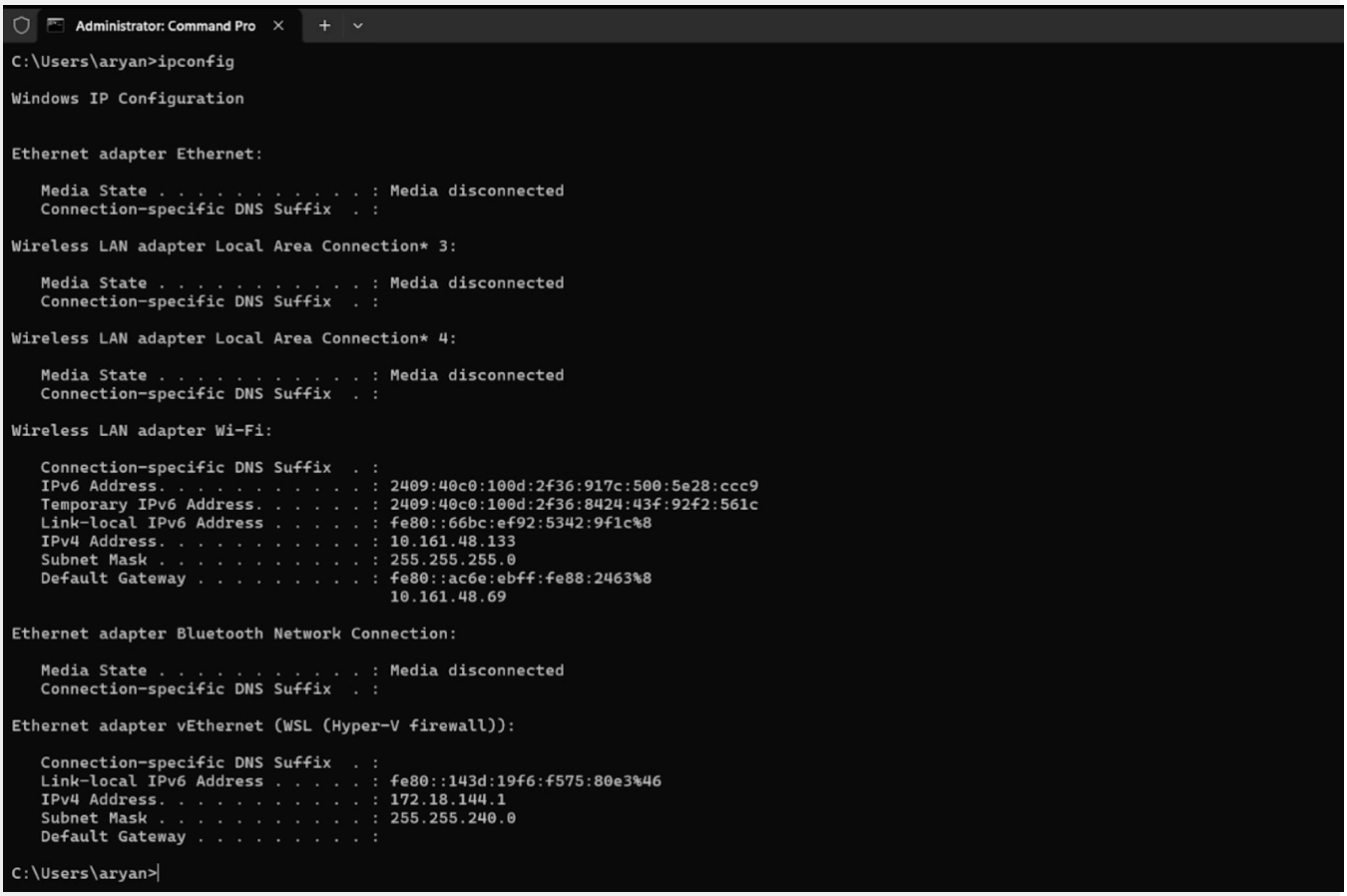


6 - Configure NSClient++

Edit the NSClient++ configuration file and add the Nagios server's IP address to the allowed hosts list:

```
PS C:\Program Files\NSClient++> notepad nsclient.ini
```

allowed hosts=127.0.0.1,192.168.1.100




```
[/modules]

NRPEServer = enabled
WEBServer = enabled
CheckDisk = enabled
CheckSystem = enabled
CheckEventLog = enabled
CheckHelpers = enabled
CheckExternalScripts = enabled
CheckNSCP = enabled


[/settings/NRPE/server]

port = 5666
verify mode = none
tls version = tlsv1.2+
insecure = true


[/settings/default]

allowed hosts = 127.0.0.1,172.17.0.1,10.161.48.133
```

Where 192.168.1.100 is your Nagios server (Docker host) IP address.

After saving the file, restart the NSClient++ service so the change takes effect:

```
PS C:\Users\vishal> Restart-Service nscp
```

```
C:\Users\aryan>sc stop nscp

SERVICE_NAME: nscp
        TYPE               : 10  WIN32_OWN_PROCESS
        STATE              : 3  STOP_PENDING
                               (STOPPABLE, NOT_PAUSABLE, IGNORES_SHUTDOWN)
        WIN32_EXIT_CODE    : 0  (0x0)
        SERVICE_EXIT_CODE  : 0  (0x0)
        CHECKPOINT         : 0x2
        WAIT_HINT          : 0x0

C:\Users\aryan>sc start nscp

SERVICE_NAME: nscp
        TYPE               : 10  WIN32_OWN_PROCESS
        STATE              : 2  START_PENDING
                               (NOT_STOPPABLE, NOT_PAUSABLE, IGNORES_SHUTDOWN)
        WIN32_EXIT_CODE    : 0  (0x0)
        SERVICE_EXIT_CODE  : 0  (0x0)
        CHECKPOINT         : 0x1
        WAIT_HINT          : 0xbb8
        PID                : 2248
        FLAGS              :

C:\Users\aryan>sc query nscp

SERVICE_NAME: nscp
        TYPE               : 10  WIN32_OWN_PROCESS
        STATE              : 4  RUNNING
                               (STOPPABLE, NOT_PAUSABLE, IGNORES_SHUTDOWN)
        WIN32_EXIT_CODE    : 0  (0x0)
        SERVICE_EXIT_CODE  : 0  (0x0)
        CHECKPOINT         : 0x0
        WAIT_HINT          : 0x0

C:\Users\aryan>
```

7 - Verify Connectivity from Nagios

From the Nagios server (inside the Docker container), run the NRPE check against the Windows remote host to confirm connectivity. Here 192.168.1.50 is the remote Windows host's IP address.

```
PS C:\Users\vishal> docker exec -it nagios4 /opt/nagios/libexec/check_nrpe -H 192.168.1.50
NRPE v2.15
```

```
C:\Users\aryan>docker exec -it nagios4 /opt/nagios/libexec/check_nrpe -H 10.161.48.133
I (0.19.0 2026-09-07) seem to be doing fine...
```

8 - Add the Windows Host in Nagios

Create a configuration file for the new host inside the Nagios container. We also define a service that continuously checks whether the host is reachable (PING check).

```
PS C:\Users\vishal> docker exec -it nagios4 sh -c "vi /opt/nagios/etc/servers/MyWindowsHost001.cfg"
define host {
  use             windows-server
  host_name       Windows_Host_001
```

```
    alias           Windows Host 001
    address         192.168.1.50
    register        1
}
define service{
    host_name               Windows_Host_001
    service_description     PING
    check_command           check_ping!100.0,20%!500.0,60%
    max_check_attempts      2
    check_interval          2
    retry_interval          2
    check_period            24x7
    check_freshness         1
    contact_groups          admins
    notification_interval   2
    notification_period     24x7
    notifications_enabled   1
    register                1
}
```

```
C:\Users\aryan>docker exec nagios4 cat /opt/nagios/etc/servers/MyWindowsHost001.cfg
define host {
  use windows-server
  host_name Windows_Host_001
  alias Windows Host 001
  address 10.161.48.133
  register 1
}

define service{
  host_name Windows_Host_001
  service_description PING
  check_command check_ping!100.0,20%%!500.0,60%%
  max_check_attempts 2
  check_interval 2
  retry_interval 2
  check_period 24x7
  check_freshness 1
  contact_groups admins
  notification_interval 2
  notification_period 24x7
  notifications_enabled 1
  register 1
}

C:\Users\aryan>
```

Verify the configuration file for errors, then restart the Nagios container so the changes take effect:

```
PS C:\Users\vishal> docker exec -it nagios4 /opt/nagios/bin/nagios -v /opt/nagios/etc/nagios.cfg
```

PS C:\Users\vishal> docker restart nagios4

```
C:\Users\aryan>docker exec -it nagios4 /opt/nagios/bin/nagios -v /opt/nagios/etc/nagios.cfg

Nagios Core 4.5.12
Copyright (c) 2009-present Nagios Core Development Team and Community Contributors
Copyright (c) 1999-2009 Ethan Galstad
Last Modified: 2026-03-25
License: GPL

Website: https://www.nagios.org
Reading configuration data...
   Read main config file okay...
   Read object config files okay...

Running pre-flight check on configuration data...

Checking objects...
       Checked 7 services.
       Checked 1 hosts.
       Checked 1 host groups.
       Checked 0 service groups.
       Checked 1 contacts.
       Checked 1 contact groups.
       Checked 23 commands.
       Checked 5 time periods.
       Checked 0 host escalations.
       Checked 0 service escalations.
Checking for circular paths...
       Checked 1 hosts
       Checked 0 service dependencies
       Checked 0 host dependencies
       Checked 5 timeperiods
Checking global event handlers...
Checking obsessive compulsive processor commands...
Checking misc settings...

Total Warnings: 0
Total Errors:   0

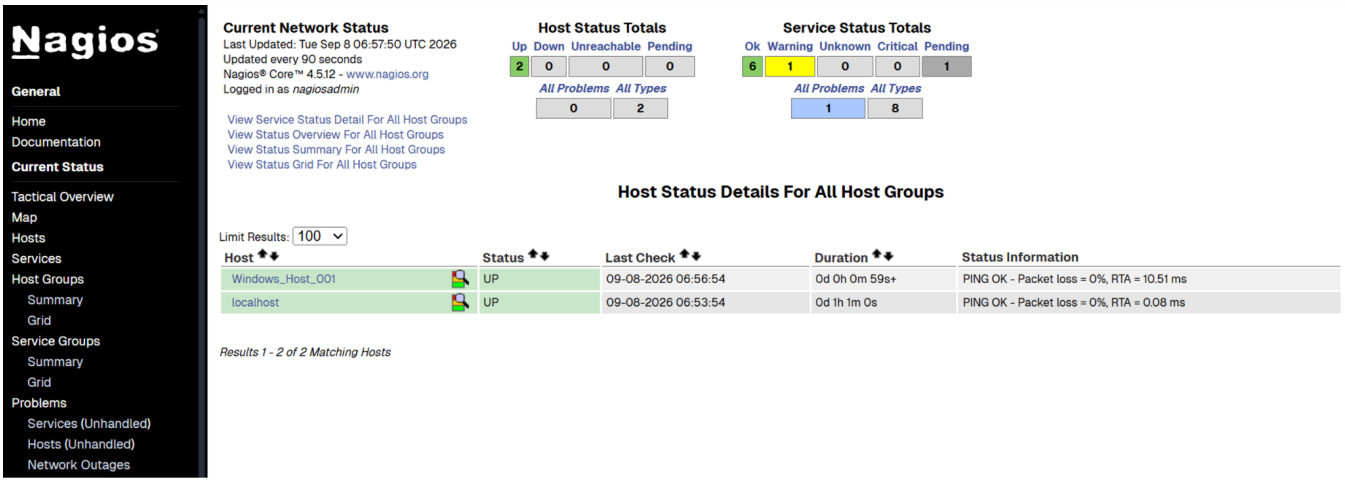
Things look okay - No serious problems were detected during the pre-flight check

What's next:
    Try Docker Debug for seamless, persistent debugging tools in any container or image → docker debug nagios4
    Learn more at https://docs.docker.com/go/debug-cli/

C:\Users\aryan>
```

9 - Check Host in Nagios Web Interface

Open the Nagios web interface (http://localhost:8080/nagios/) and check that the new Windows host has been added and is being monitored under Current Status -> Hosts.



Current Network Status
Last Updated: Tue Sep 8 06:58:57 UTC 2026
Updated every 90 seconds
Nagios® Core™ 4.5.12 - www.nagios.org
Logged in as *nagiosadmin*

View History For all hosts
View Notifications For All Hosts
View Host Status Detail For All Hosts

Host Status Totals

Up	Down	Unreachable	Pending
2	0	0	0

All Problems	All Types
0	2

Service Status Totals

Ok	Warning	Unknown	Critical	Pending
7	1	0	0	0

All Problems	All Types
1	8

Service Status Details For All Hosts

Limit Results: 100

Host	Service	Status	Last Check	Duration	Attempt	Status Information
Windows_Host_001	PING	OK	09-08-2026 06:58:00	0d 0h 2m 6s+	1/2	PING OK - Packet loss = 0%, RTA = 4.31 ms
localhost	Current Load	OK	09-08-2026 06:57:28	0d 1h 1m 29s	1/4	OK - load average: 0.13, 0.06, 0.07
	Current Users	OK	09-08-2026 06:58:11	0d 1h 0m 46s	1/4	USERS OK - 0 users currently logged in
	HTTP	WARNING	09-08-2026 06:56:54	0d 0h 57m 3s	4/4	HTTP WARNING: HTTP/1.1 401 Unauthorized - 695 bytes in 0.002 second response time
	PING	OK	09-08-2026 06:54:37	0d 0h 59m 20s	1/4	PING OK - Packet loss = 0%, RTA = 0.07 ms
	Root Partition	OK	09-08-2026 06:55:20	0d 0h 58m 37s	1/4	DISK OK - free space: / 973561 MiB (99.48% inode=100%):
	Swap Usage	OK	09-08-2026 06:56:03	0d 0h 57m 54s	1/4	SWAP OK - 100% free (2048 MB out of 2048 MB)
	Total Processes	OK	09-08-2026 06:56:46	0d 0h 57m 11s	1/4	PROCS OK: 44 processes with STATE = RSZDT

Results 1 - 8 of 8 Matching Services

Nagios

General
Home
Documentation
Current Status
Tactical Overview
Map
Hosts
Services
Host Groups
Summary
Grid
Service Groups
Summary
Grid
Problems
Services (Unhandled)
Hosts (Unhandled)
Network Outages
Quick Search:
Reports
Availability
Trends
Alerts
History

Service Information
Last Updated: Tue Sep 8 06:59:10 UTC 2026
Updated every 90 seconds
Nagios® Core™ 4.5.12 - www.nagios.org
Logged in as *nagiosadmin*

View Information For This Host
View Status Detail For This Host
View Alert History For This Service
View Trends For This Service
View Alert Histogram For This Service
View Availability Report For This Service
View Notifications For This Service

Service
PING
On Host
Windows Host 001
(Windows_Host_001)

Member of
No servicegroups.

192.168.31.230

Service State Information

Current Status:	OK (for 0d 0h 2m 19s+)
Status Information:	PING OK - Packet loss = 0%, RTA = 4.31 ms
Performance Data:	rta=4.306000ms;100.000000;500.000000;0.000000 pl=0%;20;60;0
Current Attempt:	1/2 (HARD state)
Last Check Time:	09-08-2026 06:58:00
Check Type:	ACTIVE
Check Latency / Duration:	0.000 / 4.025 seconds
Next Scheduled Check:	09-08-2026 07:00:00
Last State Change:	N/A
Last Notification:	N/A (notification 0)
Is This Service Flapping?	NO (0.00% state change)
In Scheduled Downtime?	NO
Last Update:	09-08-2026 06:59:00 (0d 0h 0m 10s ago)

Active Checks:	ENABLED
Passive Checks:	ENABLED
Obsessing:	ENABLED
Notifications:	ENABLED
Event Handler:	ENABLED
Flap Detection:	ENABLED

Service Commands
Disable active checks of this service
Re-schedule the next check of this service
Submit passive check result for this service
Stop accepting passive checks for this service
Stop obsessing over this service
Disable notifications for this service
Send custom service notification
Schedule downtime for this service
Disable event handler for this service
Disable flap detection for this service
Clear flapping state for this service

Conclusion:

In this experiment, continuous monitoring was successfully set up using Nagios Core running inside a Docker container on Windows via WSL2. The remote Windows host was integrated into the Nagios monitoring infrastructure using the NSClient++ monitoring agent. Through proper configuration of allowed hosts and NRPE service checks, host status and service metrics (such as PING responses) were verified and visually tracked via the Nagios Web Interface. This demonstrates how Nagios can be effectively utilized to maintain visibility, proactively detect infrastructure issues, and ensure system availability.